Halcyon Labs - Incident Response Runbook

This runbook is fictional sample content for the DocChat demo.

1. Severity levels

SEV1: FieldCast is unavailable for all customers, or forecasts are wrong for more than 10% of fields. Page the on-call engineer immediately and open an incident channel named #inc-<date>-<short-name>.

SEV2: A major feature is degraded (for example, SMS frost alerts are delayed by more than 15 minutes). Page on-call during core hours only.

SEV3: Minor issue with a workaround. Raise a ticket; no page needed.

2. Roles during an incident

Incident Commander (IC): coordinates the response and makes decisions. The IC does not debug; their job is communication and prioritisation.

Communications Lead: posts status page updates every 30 minutes for SEV1 and every 60 minutes for SEV2.

Subject Matter Experts: investigate and fix, reporting to the IC.

3. Escalation

If the on-call engineer does not acknowledge a page within 5 minutes, PagerDuty escalates to the secondary on-call. After 15 minutes it escalates to the Head of Engineering, Priya Raman.

4. After the incident

Every SEV1 and SEV2 incident needs a blameless post-mortem, published within 5 working days. The post-mortem must include a timeline, the root cause, customer impact, and at least one follow-up action with an owner and a due date.

Post-mortems are reviewed in the fortnightly reliability meeting, held every other Wednesday at 14:00.

5. Customer credits

Estate customers receive a 10% service credit for any month in which availability falls below 99.9%.